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From: Digital Training Centre, part of Sector 3 Group Ltd. Contact: Miles Ward, miles.ward@sector3group.co.uk, 07904 946327

To: Army Cadet Charitable Trust UK (ACCT UK), Regulated Training Centre

Reference: DTC/ACCT/03

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DIGITAL TRAINING CENTRE: PROPOSAL FOR ACF FIRST AID INSTRUCTORS

AIM

1. To propose the Digital Training Centre as the single digital system for delivering, assessing, evidencing and quality assuring every ACF first aid course, licensed per first aid instructor, with learners and cadets free of charge.

BACKGROUND

2. ACF first aid courses still run on paper: question sets, answer sheets, Annex D, E and F, nominal rolls and feedback forms are printed, hand-marked, scanned and posted to HQ within four weeks, and personal data travels in instructors' cars and homes until submitted. The Digital Training Centre was built by serving ACF instructors around the forms and IQA process they use.

WHO WE ARE

3. The Digital Training Centre is part of Sector 3 Group Ltd and is run by two serving ACF first aid instructors with professional emergency-service and training backgrounds:
 - a. **Paul Bowyer**, Station Commander, Surrey Fire Brigade; Surrey ACF.
 - b. **Miles Ward**, Clinical Education and Ambulance Technician; Essex ACF.
4. References are available from Babcock (training delivery for London Fire Brigade). Sector 3 Group Ltd is registered with the ICO; Cyber Essentials certification is pending.

WHAT IS INCLUDED

5. It runs in a web browser on any phone, tablet or laptop, nothing to install, and learners use their own phones. Each instructor licence includes:
 - a. **Course Matrix and official paperwork.** QR registration and theory exams on learners' own phones; Annex D, E and F, answer sheets and evaluation forms built automatically, with a local IQA check before submission.
 - b. **Standardisation and practical tools.** Full practical skill recording, scenario cards, sound board and QR quiz games, so every county teaches and assesses the same way.
 - c. **Learner support.** Additional learning needs captured at registration; extra time, read-aloud and coloured screens in exams.
 - d. **Free LMS for all courses**, including the Level 3 Award in Education and Training.
 - e. **Instructor CPD centre and certificate centre.** CPD, teaching hours and certificates in one place for revalidation.
 - f. **Asset management.** Each county keeps its own equipment log and service records.
 - g. **Notice board** for national messages and updates to instructors.
 - h. **Exam security.** Answer keys never leave the server, a rotating room code stops papers being shared, and there are no photocopied papers to lose.
 - i. **Same-day response** to support tickets.

BENEFITS

Area	Benefit
Instant reporting	Course status, results and IQA progress visible live to counties and ACCT UK, with no missing or chased paperwork.
GDPR	Personal data held in one controlled system with access by role, reducing the risk of loss or breach in transit.
Net zero	No printing, toner or posting of course packs.
Volunteer time	Paperwork reduced from hours to minutes per course, giving time back to volunteers.
LMS (free and included)	A fully featured, immersive learning platform for every course, including the Level 3 Award in Education and Training: digital workbooks submitted and marked online, quizzes and progress tracking. Transfer of current learners is included.
Trainer observations	Trainer observations completed digitally and kept with the instructor's record for revalidation.
Resource centre	Hand-outs, course documents and learning resources for every course in one place.

COST

6. **Pricing.** The standard commercial rate is £8.60 per instructor per month. ACCT UK is offered the banded rate card at Annex A: each instructor is charged at the rate for the band they fall in (bands are not applied to all instructors), with lower rates for 24- and 36-month agreements. Learners and cadets are free. All prices exclude VAT.

Item	Price (excluding VAT)
Initial design and development	£1,500 one-off, including set-up and online training for instructors and the IQA team
Instructor licences	Per instructor per month, banded by number of instructors and length of agreement (Annex A)
Pilot	Free: three months in two counties

7. **Illustration:** 200 licensed instructors (figures to be confirmed against ACCT UK's instructor numbers):

Agreement	Per month	Per year	Agreement value	Average per instructor
12 months	£1,510.15	£18,122	£18,122	£7.55
24 months	£1,430.15	£17,162	£34,324	£7.15
36 months	£1,350.15	£16,202	£48,605	£6.75

8. **Terms.** Live within 4 weeks of agreement. Licences are active instructor accounts, reviewed quarterly. Invoiced annually in advance. Prices fixed for the first 12 months, then reviewed annually, capped at CPI. Agreements run for the full term chosen; the 24- and 36-month rates apply to the whole term and early termination is only for material breach. Either party may give 3 months' notice before the end of the term; otherwise it renews for 12 months at the then-current rates. ICO registered; Cyber Essentials pending; insurance details on request.
9. **Data.** Secure cloud database with daily backups and role-based access; data-processing agreement and DPIA support provided; all ACF data returned at the end of the agreement.

DECLARATION OF INTEREST

10. Miles Ward (Essex ACF) and Paul Bowyer (Surrey ACF) are serving CFAV and run the Digital Training Centre through Sector 3 Group Ltd. This interest is declared; any agreement would be between ACCT UK and Sector 3 Group Ltd, and pilot counties would be selected by ACCT UK.

RECOMMENDATION

11. It is recommended that ACCT UK approves a free three-month pilot in two counties, with the IQA team reviewing every course pack through the system, confirms its instructor numbers and procurement threshold, and decides on the agreement term by 28 Feb 27.

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ANNEX A: INSTRUCTOR LICENCE RATE CARD

Per instructor per month, excluding VAT. Each instructor is charged at the rate for the band they fall in; moving into a lower band does not change the rate for instructors already in earlier bands. The 36-month, 500+ rate is the lowest rate offered.

Instructors (band)	12-month agreement	24-month agreement	36-month agreement
1 to 49	£8.60	£8.20	£7.80
50 to 99	£7.75	£7.35	£6.95
100 to 199	£6.95	£6.55	£6.15
200 to 299	£6.25	£5.85	£5.45
300 to 399	£5.60	£5.20	£4.80
400 to 499	£4.95	£4.60	£4.30
500 and above	£4.60	£4.35	£4.10

How the bands work: example of 120 instructors on a 12-month agreement:

Band	Instructors	Rate	Per month
1 to 49	49	£8.60	£421.40
50 to 99	50	£7.75	£387.50
100 to 199	21	£6.95	£145.95
Total	120	average £7.96	£954.85 + VAT

Further illustrations (per month, excluding VAT):

Instructors	12 months	24 months	36 months
120	£954.85	£906.85	£858.85
200	£1,510.15	£1,430.15	£1,350.15
300	£2,134.50	£2,014.50	£1,894.50
450	£2,941.35	£2,763.90	£2,589.00
500	£3,188.50	£2,993.65	£2,803.80

Learners, cadets, IQA and administrator accounts are free. Set-up and training £1,500 one-off. Invoiced annually in advance; prices reviewed annually after the first 12 months, capped at CPI.